SENIOR SIX HISTORY SEMINAR ITEMS

TO BE HELD ON 25TH 09, 2026

SECTION A

ITEM 1

After attaining independence in the early 1960s, Uganda, Kenya and Tanzania adopted different state ideologies to guide their social, economic and political development. For instance, Tanzania, under President Julius Nyerere, adopted Ujamaa policy also called African socialism. Kenya under Jomo Kenyatta, promoted Harambee policy. These ideologies aimed at improving the socio-economic conditions and promoting the well-being of citizens.

Today, some communities in Uganda are struggling with severe poverty, multiple infrastructure gaps: shortage of water, electricity and poor roads that become impassable during heavy rains. Shortage of qualified staff and drugs in health centres forcing residents to travel long distances for basic treatment. The local leaders have recognised that individual household efforts are not enough. They are now calling for the community to adopt the Ujamaa and Harambee ideologies to solve these problems.

Task:

(a) Analyse the ideologies in the scenario in addressing post-independence challenges of their countries.
(b) Evaluate the ideologies to address the challenges identified in the scenario?

ITEM 2

The First and Second World Wars were among the most destructive events in human history. World War I (1914–1918) caused the death of about 13 million people, while World War II (1939-1945) claimed between 50 and 70 million lives. Historians have identified several factors that contributed to the outbreak of these wars, including aggressive nationalism, imperialism, alliance systems, arms races, aggressive leaders, weak international organizations, and acts of aggression by powerful states. These factors created tension, mistrust, fear, and hostility among nations, eventually leading to large-scale global conflicts.

Although World War II ended in 1945, many world leaders are worried because some conditions that contributed to the two world wars seem to be reappearing today. Relations among major powers have become increasingly tense. Rivalries involving countries the United States, China, and Russia continue to grow. Military alliances

are expanding, countries are investing heavily in advanced weapons, and several regions are experiencing proxy wars and territorial disputes. At the same time, ideological differences, aggressive nationalism, economic competition, misinformation through the media, and the weaknesses of some international organisations continue to create fear and suspicion among states. Concerned that these developments could threaten international peace and possibly lead to another conflict, the United Nations has organised a Global Peace Summit. The summit has brought together world leaders and representatives of international organizations to discuss how mistakes can be avoided today. Your country's leader has been invited to present a speech at the summit. To gather views from citizens, she has launched a nationwide consultation programme. As a result of your outstanding academic performance, your school has selected you to present ideas that will help shape your country's contribution to the summit.

Task:

(a) Analyse the causes of world wars as mentioned in the scenario.
(b) Evaluate lessons that can be adopted by world leaders to prevent the occurrence of a third world war today.

ITEM 3

The years following World War I were marked by a series of destabilizing activities that resulted in the Great Depression of 1929. The harsh reparations imposed on Germany by the Treaty of Versailles crippled its economy and disrupted European trade, while heavy reliance on American loans created a fragile interdependence among nations. Reckless stock market speculation in the United States, overproduction in agriculture and industry, and uneven distribution of wealth further weakened economic foundations. When the Wall Street Crash of 1929 occurred, panic spread rapidly across industrialized economies. By 1935, this severe economic crisis was over as countries set up trading blocs, socio-econ reforms, reduced interest rates, raised taxes on the wealthy.

Today, some States in Tukas region are facing rising household debt, mass unemployment, high gambling / betting, growing income inequality, limited trading among tribes. These conditions expose the region to severe economic shocks if left unaddressed. The citizens are now calling upon the leaders for proactive measures to safeguard the region / states using various measures that helped industrialized countries to overcome the great depression by 1935.

Task:

(a) Analyse the inter-war events and activities in the scenario that caused the Great Depression of 1929.
(b) Evaluate the strategies of the industrialized world to address the challenges in Tukas region.

ITEM 4

After World War I in 1900s, some European countries adopted authoritarianism

extremism in their governance. These came to be known as Fascism and Nazism which were adopted by Benito Mussolini in Italy around 1922 and Adolf Hitler in Germany around 1933 respectively. These grew due to economic hardships, political instability, fear of communism and dissatisfaction with post-war conditions.

Fascism and Nazism had profound impact on Europe contributing directly to World War II which caused massive destruction, millions of deaths and widespread economic hardships the atrocities committed by the Nazi regime including the Holocaust, led European countries to strengthening democracy, human rights protections and international cooperation after war.

Their legacy continues to influence global politics today as governments and international organizations remain vigilant against authoritarianism, racism and extremist movements. Debates about nationalism, populism and democratic values are often shaped by lessons learned from the rise and consequences of Fascism and Nazism in the twentieth century.

Task

(a) Analyze the impact of the two ideologies mentioned in the scenario on modern Europe.
(b) Explain how these ideologies have influenced the present international order.

ITEM 5

Global and regional politics in the Middle East show that the region has been a center

of conflict, oil politics, and competing nationalisms since 1984. This has attracted

regional, continental, and global intervention to bring stability, peace, and development.

Between 1948 and 1978, the relationship between Palestine and Israel was tense because of the creation of the new state of Israel in Palestine. This led to the

displacement of hundreds of thousands of Palestinians. This event is called the Palestinian Nakba meaning "catastrophe". It created a refugee crisis and deep h between the two peoples.

The rise of the Palestinian Liberation Organization (PLO) in 1964 marked the Palestinian resistance against Israel. The 1967 Six-Day War made things wo Israel captured the West Bank, the Gaza Strip, East Jerusalem, and the Golan heights.

More wars followed, including the Yom Kippur War of 1973, which increased tension in the region. Although efforts were made in the Camp David Accord of 1978 to bring peace and dialogue, mistrust has continued in the region up to the present day.

A regional, continental, and global forum invites you to provide guidance on the historical development described above.

Task:

(a) Analyze the possible factors that led to the 1948 – 1978 conflict in
(b) Using regional, continental, and global knowledge, suggest how modern leaders can find a lasting solution to the conflict mentioned above.

SECTION B

ITME 6

Between 1789 and 1848, Europe experienced two major revolutions that is the 1789 French revolution and the 1848 Revolutions in various states. The French revolution became a major turning point on the European continent as the French masses rose up against their king Louis XVI of the bourbon monarchy, Challenging feudalism, absolute Monarchism.

On the other hand, the 1848 Revolution broke out in February in France against the Orleans Monarchy under King Louis Phillippe, then spread to the Austrian Empire, Italian and Germany states. Only Belgium and Britain Survived the Revolutions. Together the Revolutions of 1789 and1848 transformed Europe politically, Socially and economically as they undermined feudalism, encouraged nationalism among others.

Today leaders in Uganda faces growing pressure from citizens who demand accountable governance, respect for constitutionalism, protection of human rights and better service delivery. Despite constant requests for solutions from the government, not much has been realized. Elders from different regions of the country have organized a meeting to come up with strategies on how best the situation can be peacefully handled.

Task

(a) Asses the consequences of the 1789-1848 revolutions in Europe presented in the scenario.
(b) Recommend strategies leaders in Uganda can apply to promote accountable governance, peaceful reforms and national unity.

ITEM 7

Napoleon Bonaparte was born at Ajjacio, Corsica Island in the Italian State Genoa on the 15th August 1769, one year after the state had by France. Many Factors led to the rise of Napoleon to power in France but most importantly the outbreak of the 1789 French revolution that created power vacuum after the death of important personalities such as King Louis XV, Maximillien Robspiere, Danton among others. After his rise to power in 1799, he embarked on a number of reforms both in domestic and foreign policies, among which included; Code Napoleon, education, strengthened the French military that expanded France's boundaries after defeating European powers such as Russia, Prussia by 1807, Indeed by 1807 Napoleon had reached his peak, after defeating most of his neighbouring states. However, from

then on wards, Napoleon's military power started declining facing several defeats such as the Peninsular wars of 1808 in which he was defeated by Spain and later in 1812, was disastrously defeated by Russia during the Moscow Campaign in which lost over five + hundred thousand soldiers which greatly weakened him explaining his downfall by 1815.

In modern world today, Captain Ibrahim Traore the president of Burkina Faso took power in September 2022 through a military coup, overthrowing Paul Henri Damiba and quickly became one of the most loved and famous leaders in west Africa because of his reforms to the people.

However, despite his achievements, he has faced several assassinations attempts from within and outside the country, the constant rebel attacks groups such as the Islamic State. These have all threatened to overthrow his government. Some military leaders in West Africa such as the president of Mali, Niger, Guinea are concerned about the situation in Burkina Faso that is threatening into outbreak of a conflict. They have therefore organized a conference to find ways of resolving the conflicts.

Task

a) Examine the factors that led to the downfall of Napoleon Bonarpate from power in France as presented in the scenario.
b) Recommend the strategies west African leaders can adopt to avoid the decline of captain Traore's government.

ITEM 8

In the early nineteenth century, Europe had suffered many years of war because of the French Revolution and the conquests of Napoleon Bonaparte. The revolutionary and Napoleonic w destroyed cities, killed many people, and upset old governments. After Napoleon was defeated in 1815, leaders from the major powers of Europe met in Vienna and later in a series of meetings, such as the meeting of Aix-la-Chapelle, 1818, Troppau, 1820, Laibach, 1821, Verona, 1822, among others. The main countries involved were Austria, Britain, Russia, Prussia, and later France. The main goals of these meetings were to discuss how to create lasting peace, redraw the map of Europe, guard against further French aggression, restore balance of power and legitimate rulers in Europe, and maintain an effective alliance that would peacefully discuss and solve continental problems. These meetings brought about relative peace to Europe for almost forty years, although they also had serious problems that even to their collapse by 1830 .

Recently, the Middle East has been facing many serious conflicts, including wars, rising tensions between regional powers, terrorism, and challenges of refugee and economic crises. Many countries worry that without better cooperation, these problems could lead to wider instability, loss of lives, destruction, and economic hardship. Because of this, there have been calls for stronger international meetings and systems to solve regional problems peacefully

Task:

a) Analyse the achievements of the objectives of statesmen mentioned in the scenario.
b) Recommend lessons that can be adopted from them to prevent similar challenges in the Middle East.

ITEM 9

The years 1931-1856, witnessed two major bloody events in the ottoman Empire namely; the Syrian crisis of 1831- 1841 and the Crimean 1854- 56. The Syrian crisis was a conflict between the sultan of turkey and his Governor Mehmet Ali of Egypt over the control of Syria. The Crimean war on the other hand was fought on the Crimean Peninsula found on the Black Sea. Between Russia on one side against Turkey, Britain, France and later joined by piedmont (Italy). These two conflicts broke out due to the military weakness of the Turkish Empire, Ru aggressiveness among others. These conflicts came to be known as the Eastern Question as they attracted the involvement of the great p of Europe.

Today, Uganda is located in a strategically important region of Africa where political instability in the neighboring countries, competition over natural resources, boarder tensions, refugee movements, and the influence of external powers often affects peace and security. This has disrupted trade, investment and national development. Various leaders in Uganda are concerned about the above situation. They are now planning to hold a conference to find strategies of bringing peace to the region.

Task

a) Analyze the causes of the Eastern Question between 1831-1856 as presented in the scenario.
b) Recommend solutions which Uganda and its leaders can adopt to manage regional tensions, protect national interests and promote peace in East Africa.

ITEM 10

The Balkan Conflicts of 1908–1913 were among the most dangerous crises in early twen century Europe. These crises can be traced back to the Crimean War of 1854–1856, which exposed the deep rivalry between European powers over the weakening Ottoman Empire.

Although the Treaty of Paris (1856) ended the war, it failed to resolve the Eastern Question, and the Ottoman Empire continued to decline, encouraging competition among Russia, Britain, France, and Austria-Hungary over influence in the Balkans. This rivalry was intensified by the Russo-Turkish War of 1877–1878 and the decisions of the Berlin Congress of 1878, which created new Balkan states but also left deep grievances through unequal territorial settlements and rising nationalism. By the early twentieth century, these long-term tensions, combined with aggressive nationalism, Pan-Slavism, Austro-Hungarian expansion, and the continued collapse of Ottoman authority, transformed the Balkans into a volatile region where the conflicts of 1908–1913 involving Serbia, Bulgaria, Greece, Montenegro, and the Great Powers ultimately reshaped Southeastern Europe.

Mediterranean states today are facing persistent rivalry. These states compete over territory, access to the sea, control of strategic trade routes, and influence over smaller ethnic and cultural groups, making the region unstable and prone to conflict. The situation is further complicated by mistrust, competing national ambitions, and external influence from powerful states seeking strategic and economic advantage in the region. Concerned that such patterns of rivalry may threaten long-term peace and stability in the Mediterranean region, regional leaders are investigating how such tensions can be managed and resolved without escalating into a wider regional war. Various students are requested to contribute ideas to the discussion, and you are one of them.

Task

a) Examine the causes of the Balkan Conflicts (1908-1913) as mentioned in the scenario.
b) Recommend lessons that leaders of the Mediterranean region can adopt to promote long lasting peace in the region.

ITEM 11

During a global forum on state formation and consolidation, Political Scientists and Researchers convened to discuss a topic about nation building and governance. During a panel discussion, a historian presented the case of the Turkish Empire, which rose from a small frontier principality in Anatolia in the late 13th century to become one of the most powerful empires stretching through Europe, Asia, and North Africa. The speaker highlighted several key factors behind the empire's rise. He observed that the conquest of Constantinople in 1453 was a turning point, marking the end of the Byzantine Empire and the emergence of the Ottomans as a dominant power in Europe. This expansion had profound effects on European states including the disruption of traditional trade routes, which encouraged European exploration and the search for alternative sea routes to Asia, during an open discussion session, participants noted that many modern states especially in Africa, face challenges related to state formation, national unity, governance, and managing diversity. The summit concluded by urging learners to analyze historical empires like the Ottoman Empire to draw lessons on how strong institutions, leadership, and inclusive governance can contribute stable and unified states.

Task

a) Using the scenario and your understanding of History; analyze the key factors that led to rise of the Ottoman Empire.

b) Discuss what modern countries especially in Africa can draw from this experience about building a strong, stable and a well-organized society.

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